

## First bullet train

- **What?** *Shinkansen*
- **Who?** Japan Railways
- **Where and when?** Japan, 1964

In 1964, railroads were given a dramatic new lease on life when streamlined electric “bullet” trains, or *Shinkansen*, were introduced in Japan. They ran very fast on specially constructed tracks with gentle curves. Today, high-speed trains run in many countries around the world.



## Maglevs

- **What?** Shanghai Maglev Train (SMT)
- **Who?** Siemens and ThyssenKrupp
- **Where and when?** China, 2004

The fastest trains in the world have no wheels and no engine. High-powered magnets move the trains and make them float above the track. These trains are called “maglevs,” which is short for magnetic levitation. The SMT airport train runs at up to 267 mph (430 km/h).



*A magnet on the track repels the magnet on the underside of the train to make the train float above the track.*

## Fastest bullet train

- **What?** *Fuxing*
- **Who?** China Railway Corps
- **Where and when?** China, 2017

China now has the world's fastest bullet trains. Their newest trains, named *Fuxing* (which means “regeneration”), can reach

a maximum speed of 248 mph (400 km/h) and operate at an average speed of 217 mph (350 km/h). The trains can complete the 819-mile (1,318-km) journey from Beijing to Shanghai in China in just four and a half hours.

